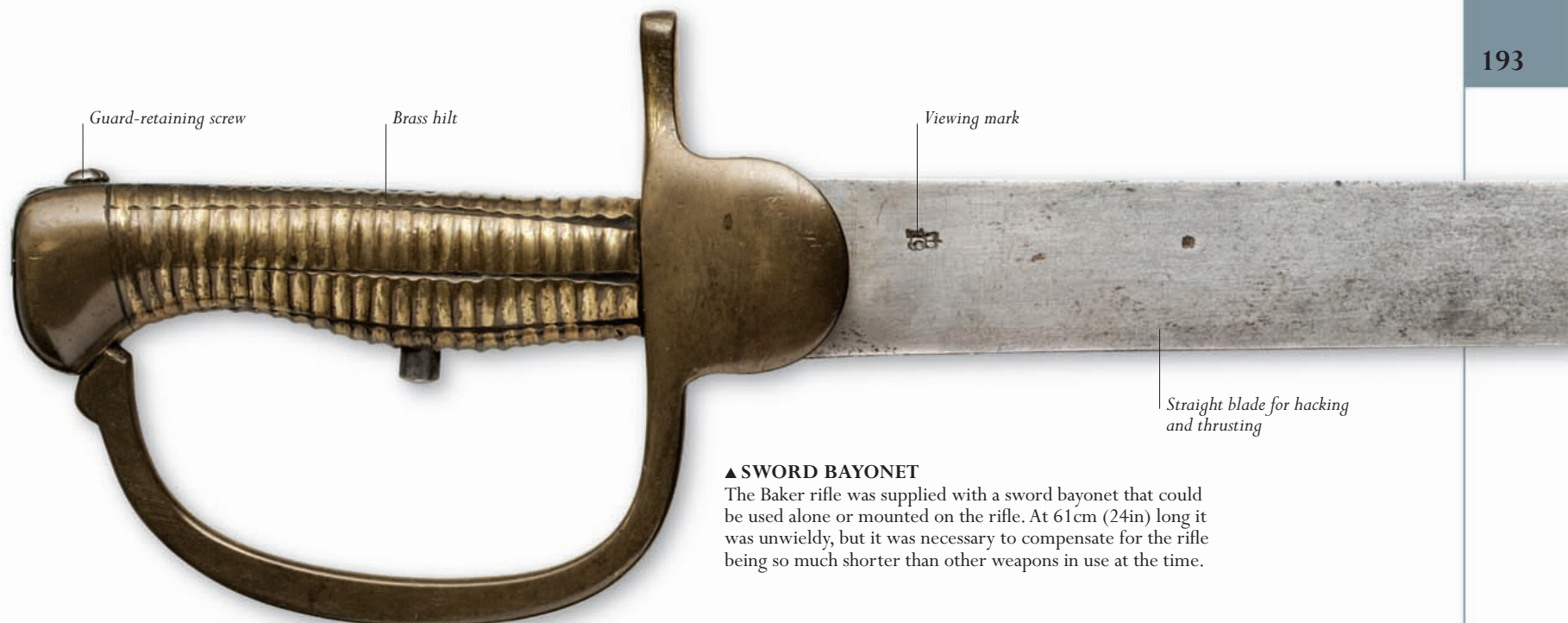




▲ SWORD BAYONET

The Baker rifle was supplied with a sword bayonet that could be used alone or mounted on the rifle. At 61cm (24in) long it was unwieldy, but it was necessary to compensate for the rifle being so much shorter than other weapons in use at the time.



◀ PAPER-WRAPPED CARTRIDGE

This contained a charge of powder and a lead ball. To load a shot, the rifleman tore it open with his teeth, leaving the ball in the paper. He poured a small portion of the charge into the pan and the rest down the muzzle, and rammed the paper down the barrel with the ramrod to form a wad. He then rammed the ball down on top, wrapped in a patch taken from the patchbox.

► RAMROD

The steel rod was used to ram the charge and projectile into the barrel.



Sling could be used to steady the aim (see box)